

Sergio Cruz

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior engineering leader who turns technical systems, engineering teams, and AI-enabled practices into business leverage. 15+ years in software, from first technical hire to Senior Director of Software Engineering leading multiple cross-functional teams within a 40+ person business unit that grew 67% over three years. Operates at the intersection of technology, product, and business strategy, including identifying a data-quality issue that revealed a mispriced partner program and created a projected multimillion-dollar annual revenue opportunity. Scaled engineering organizations from 2 to 15+ engineers, contributed to org-wide AI adoption across 150+ engineers, and published multiple Pluralsight courses on engineering leadership and software development. Comfortable in executive rooms, cross-functional squads, and architecture sessions.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Engineering Org Leadership | Data Pipeline Architecture | Business-Technical Integration | Revenue-Driven Technical Strategy
AI-Augmented Engineering | Executive Partnership | Team Scaling & Development | Integration Platform Design

WORK EXPERIENCE

Ramsey Solutions | Franklin, Tennessee

Senior Director of Software Engineering | Mar 2024 - Present

- Engineering leader across four cross-functional teams within a 40+ person business unit reporting to a business VP. Part of the BU leadership team, connecting engineering priorities to revenue goals and product strategy.
- **Data pipeline investigation to multimillion-dollar revenue opportunity:** Identified a MySQL casting error that masked partner profitability in a financial reporting pipeline; partnered with business leadership to reprice the program, creating a projected multimillion-dollar annual revenue opportunity.
- Led a multi-year data science initiative on a high-value partner program using random forest modeling on live transactional data, increasing close rates 60% and tripling profitability over two years.
- Led engineering for a business unit that grew 67% over three years; teams built and maintained the systems, integrations, and data infrastructure that powered that growth.
- Applied CDH continuous discovery to quarterly OKRs, helping teams track business metrics and leading indicators instead of output alone. Part of the leadership team driving company-wide Claude Code adoption across 150+ engineers.
- Key leader in the org-wide engineering growth tracks initiative: proposed behavioral criteria across six IC levels, led adoption rollout, and built the assessment tool used by engineering leaders twice yearly.

Director of Software Engineering | Mar 2021 - Mar 2024

- Scaled the engineering organization from 5 to 15+ engineers and leaders within a 40+ person cross-functional business unit, building a management layer and formal career development programs as the team tripled in size.
- Owned integration platform strategy, architecting partner data integrations that connected Ramsey customers to mortgage, insurance, and financial providers through direct system integrations and third-party APIs.
- Sat at the BU leadership table using EOS and OKRs; drove standardization of CI/CD pipelines, testing standards, and architectural patterns across multiple squads.
- Partnered with product, marketing, and operations leadership to align engineering priorities with revenue growth, customer experience, and operational scalability.

Associate Director of Software Engineering | Mar 2019 - Mar 2021

- First engineering leader for a newly formed business unit. Built the engineering function from a 2-person team while representing engineering on the BU leadership team from day one.
- Diagnosed and remediated a critical security and reliability failure in the first weeks: GET requests submitting PII exposed sensitive data in server logs and intermittently hit a 2KB load balancer limit that silently dropped requests.
- Built the initial partner integration suite across mortgage, insurance, legal, and financial services, scaling the team from 2 to 8 engineers to support 3x revenue growth.

Trazi Ventures | Orlando, Florida

Engineering Manager | May 2017 - Mar 2019

- First technical hire; built the engineering function from scratch and scaled the platform to 7-digit monthly signups and 8-digit monthly revenue.
- Defined engineering standards, owned architecture decisions, and led technical execution through rapid expansion.

Pluralsight / Code School | Orlando, Florida

Tech Lead / Software Engineer | 2015 - 2017

- Led UI engineering for a product squad building single-page applications integrated with enterprise backend systems.
- Built the Code School course builder with Docker-based sandboxes for secure code execution, reaching 10,000+ active learners.
- Spoke at industry conferences and created video content on Node.js, React, and Angular.

COURSES & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

Pluralsight Course Author | 2016, 2024-2025

Published courses: Domain-Driven Design: Working with Legacy Projects, APIs Explained, Engineering Management Processes & Tools Fundamentals, and Product Management for Engineering Managers. Earlier course: Code School: Powering up with React.

Media, Speaking & Community | 2016-2025

Featured in Exponent's engineering leadership YouTube series with 45K+ views on a 489K-subscriber channel. Conference speaker at ng-conf 2017 and 2018. Published in Net Magazine, InfoQ, and Creative Bloq. President of Orlando Devs, a nonprofit developer community with 3,000+ members, from 2016 to 2018.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Database & Data: MySQL, PostgreSQL, data pipelines, predictive analytics, random forest modeling

Backend: Node.js, Express, NestJS, Kotlin, Java, Spring Boot, Ruby on Rails

Frontend: React, Angular, TypeScript

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Docker, CI/CD, microservices, BFF architecture

AI & Automation: Claude Code, LLM orchestration, agentic workflows, Zapier integrations

Engineering Culture: Domain-Driven Design, Clean Code, Pragmatic Programmer

Leadership Frameworks: EOS, OKRs, CDH continuous discovery, engineering growth tracks